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Strathclyde
Glasgow



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Policy and Procedure for late submission of coursework

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1.2	Policy and Procedure for Late Submission of Coursework – applicable to both undergraduate and postgraduate taught courses	Assessment and Feedback Working Group	Senate	From academic year 2019-20
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Policy and procedure for late submission of coursework

Rationale

1. This policy aims to ensure an institution-wide approach to handling the late submission of students' coursework.
2. The policy is underpinned by a commitment to the fundamental objectives of fairness and of supporting students in their studies while recognising the respective responsibilities of students and staff.
3. This policy must be implemented in line with the following other related policies: [Assessment and Feedback Policy](#), the [Policy on Extensions to the Submission of Coursework](#), the [Personal Circumstances and Academic Appeals Procedure](#), and [programme regulations](#).

Definitions

4. Coursework is defined broadly as a piece of work created by students during their programme of study, that is assessed and counts towards a final mark or grade in a module.
5. Coursework is deemed to be late when it is submitted after the published submission deadline without an agreed extension.
6. Published submission dates and times shall be set to UK local time and it is the responsibility of students outside this time zone to check the corresponding submission date and time in their locale.

Scope

7. Except where not permitted for reasons of professional accreditation, the penalties for late submission of coursework shall apply to all years of undergraduate and postgraduate taught programmes.
8. In the event of a professional body indicating concern about the implementation of this policy within accredited programmes, Department staff should refer the issue to the relevant Vice Dean (Academic).
9. For some forms of continuous or integrated assessments such as projects and dissertations, the application of penalties for late submission may not be appropriate or feasible. In these cases, Departments are authorised to introduce appropriate variations to the penalty scheme set out in this policy. Any variation to the scheme must be communicated to students clearly in advance, and must be fair and supportive of students in their studies.

10. For some forms of assessment including examinations, class tests, presentations, vivas, assessed observations and practicals, where the application of late penalties is not appropriate, this policy will not apply.

Principles and guidelines for implementation

11. All staff should adhere to the following guiding principles and procedures in handling coursework that is submitted late as defined above in paragraph 5.
12. The application of the policy should not adversely impact student progression where coursework has been submitted up to and including 7 calendar days late and is of a pass standard.

Coursework submission deadline

13. It is recommended that, where feasible and the structure of the programme allows, deadlines for the submission of coursework should be set between 12.00 and 18.00 during the University's standard working week, and preferably between Monday and Thursday. This is so that students can access University support services if required close to the submission deadline. In addition, any essential technical developments to Myplace are normally scheduled to take place outside of these times.
14. Penalties will be applied to late submitted coursework up to and including seven calendar days from the submission deadline.
15. Coursework submitted later than seven calendar days after the published deadline, without an agreed extension, will receive a mark of zero.

Grace period

16. An automatic grace period of four hours will be granted to take account of unanticipated short-term issues near the submission deadline, during which no penalty will be applied.
17. When submitting coursework through Myplace, students must indicate that they wish the 'grace period' to apply and indicate the nature of the issue that has caused the late submission of the assignment.
18. IT issues and travel problems would be accepted as valid grounds for late submission for up to four hours after the submission deadline, although alone these would not be valid grounds for lengthier extension requests.
19. Penalties will be applied according to the sliding scale set out in this policy when the four-hour grace period ends.

Penalties for late submission

20. Coursework submitted after the published deadline, or approved extension deadline, will be subject to penalties on a sliding percentage scale.
21. Coursework that is submitted late, but within 24 hours of the submission deadline, or approved extension submission deadline, will be subject to a 10-point deduction on the percentage mark being applied to the original mark, until or unless the percentage mark reaches or is 40% for undergraduate coursework, or 50% for postgraduate and final year of integrated master's coursework.
22. For each subsequent day, or part day, that coursework is submitted late, up until a maximum of seven calendar days from the deadline, a penalty of 5 percentage point deduction per day or part day will be applied to the original mark until or unless the percentage mark reaches or is 40% for undergraduate coursework, or 50% for postgraduate and level 5 of integrated master's coursework.
23. For coursework submitted late (but within the seven calendar day window) that is of a pass standard, a minimum mark of 40% will be applied to undergraduate coursework; and a minimum mark of 50% will be applied to postgraduate and level 5 of integrated master's coursework.
24. For coursework submitted late (but within the seven calendar day window) where the academic quality is below the pass mark, no penalty should be applied, with the emphasis on supporting the student in any resubmission.
25. All coursework submitted before the date at which feedback is returned to students (this is usually 15 working days in line with the Assessment and Feedback Policy) will be marked at face value with feedback provided, irrespective of the final mark recorded. That is, all students should be made aware of the original mark given before the application of any penalty for late submission.,
26. Coursework submitted beyond the date at which feedback is returned to students will not be marked.
27. For coursework that is submitted only in hard copy to the Department, staff shall not include the weekend or University closure days within the calculation of penalties.

Assessments that are marked on a non-numerical scale (e.g. Pass/Fail, Satisfactory/Non-satisfactory)

28. The sliding scale penalty cannot naturally be applied to coursework marked on a non-numerical scale.
29. Where coursework is marked on a non-numerical scale, and it is submitted within seven calendar days of the submission deadline, and is of a Pass standard, the coursework will be awarded a Pass.
30. Where coursework is marked on a non-numerical scale, and it is submitted more than seven calendar days after the submission deadline, the coursework shall be awarded a Fail.

Examples of implementing the sliding penalty scale for late submitted coursework

31. The table below shows examples of implementing the sliding penalty scale for the late submission of coursework. As stated in paragraph 25, where an assessment cannot be submitted online, and the assessment is instead submitted physically to the Department on campus, the weekend and University closure days must not be included in the calculation of penalties. Staff should bear this in mind when interpreting the limitations of the examples below.

Example	Day of submission	Penalties applied	
1.	Coursework submitted after the deadline, the student has an approved extension and submits within the approved extension period.	No penalty is to be applied.	
2.	Late submission up to four hours on the day of the deadline (or approved extended deadline), the student has communicated unanticipated short-term issues and is granted a grace period of four hours after the deadline.	No penalty is to be applied.	
3.	Late submission within one calendar day (less than 24 hours) of the deadline, the student has no approved extension.	10 percentage point penalty is applied to the original mark unless the penalty reduces the student's mark to below 40% (UG) or 50% (PG), in which case the mark is capped at 40% (UG) and 50% (PG).	
		Example 1 (UG): Original mark = 68 Penalty = 10 Final mark: $68 - 10 = 58$	Example 2 (UG) Original mark = 47 Penalty = 10 Final mark: $47 - 10 = 37$ → <i>cap at 40</i>
4.	Late submission more than one full calendar day (more than 24 hours) after the deadline but less than two full calendar days (less than 48 hours) after the deadline	15 percentage point penalty (10 points for the first day, 5 points for the second day or part day), applied to the original mark, unless the penalty reduces the student's mark to below 40% (UG) or 50% (PG), in which case the mark is capped at 40% (UG) and 50% (PG).	

	has expired, the student has no approved extension.	Example 1 (PGT): Original mark = 67 Penalty = 10+5 = 15 Final mark: 67-15 = 52	Example 2 (PGT): Original mark = 57 Penalty = 10+5 = 15 Final mark: 57-15 = 42 → <i>cap at 50</i>
5.	Late submission more than two full calendar days (longer than 48 hours) after the deadline but less than three full calendar days (72 hours), the student has no approved extension.	20 percentage point penalty (10 for the first day, 5 for the second day, 5 for the third day or part day), applied to the original mark, unless the penalty reduces the student's mark to below 40% (UG) or 50% (PG), in which case the mark is capped at 40% (UG) and 50% (PG).	
6.	Late submission more than three full calendar days (longer than 72 hours) after the deadline but less than four full calendar days (less than 96 hours), the student has no approved extension.	25 percentage point penalty (10 for the first day, 5 for the second day, 5 for the third day, 5 for the fourth day or part day), applied to the original mark, unless the penalty reduces the student's mark to below 40% (UG) or 50% (PG), in which case the mark is capped at 40% (UG) and 50% (PG).	
7.	Late submission more than four full calendar days (more than 96 hours) after the deadline but less than five full calendar days (less than 120 hours), the student has no approved extension.	30 percentage point penalty (10 for the first day, 5 for the second day, 5 for the third day, 5 for the fourth day, 5 for the fifth day or part day), applied to the original mark, unless the penalty reduces the student's mark to below 40% (UG) or 50% (PG), in which case the mark is capped at 40% (UG) and 50% (PG).	
8.	Late submission more than five full calendar days (more than 120 hours) after the deadline but less than six full calendar days (less than 146 hours), the student has no approved extension.	35 percentage point penalty (10 for the first day, 5 for the second day, 5 for the third day, 5 for the fourth day, 5 for the fifth day or part day), applied to the original mark unless the penalty reduces the student's mark to below 40% (UG) or 50% (PG), in which case the mark is capped at 40% (UG) and 50% (PG).	

9.	Late submission more than six full calendar days (more than 146 hours) after the deadline but less than seven full calendar days (less than 168 hours), the student has no approved extension.	40 percentage point penalty (10 for the first day, 5 for the second day, 5 for the third day, 5 for the fourth day, 5 for the fifth day, 5 for the sixth day and 5 for the seventh part day), applied to original mark unless the penalty reduces the student's mark to below 40% (UG) or 50% (PG), in which case the mark is capped at 40% (UG) and 50% (PG).
10.	Late submission more than seven full calendar days after the deadline. For example, a deadline was set for Midday on a Wednesday and a student submits after midday the following Wednesday and has no approved extension.	A mark of zero will be applied.

Extensions

32. Students can request an extension to their coursework submission deadline when they can demonstrate that there are exceptional circumstances that are impacting their ability to meet the submission date. Students must submit their request for an extension as early as possible, and in line with the [Policy on Extensions to the Submission of Coursework](#). This must normally be before the submission deadline. For ongoing, longer-term personal issues which are negatively impacting their attendance and studies in general, students should follow the guidance set out in the [Personal Circumstances and Academic Appeals Procedure](#).

Roles and responsibilities

33. Departmental Staff are responsible for:

- Communicating this policy to students;
- Ensuring this policy is implemented consistently across programmes; and
- Reassuring students that they will not be disadvantaged if an assessment is submitted late due to known technical issues with Myplace.

34. Students are responsible for:

- Understanding the requirements of individual assessments, and actively engaging with assessment tasks by devoting appropriate time and effort;
- Finding out where, how, and when assessments are to be submitted;

- c. Communicating to staff any personal circumstances that are negatively impacting their studies via the processes outlined in the Personal Circumstances and Academic Appeals Procedure; and
- d. Requesting extensions to the deadline for coursework submission in line with the Policy on Extensions to the Submission of Coursework.